

Introduction

Time travel: the dream of man for as long as we have been dreaming. But for time travel to ever exist, it must exist at all points in time simultaneously. The Renaissance inventor creates a clockwork time machine worthy of HG Wells, the futuristic inventor has access to lasers and androids, and the Stone Age man goes, "Ug make fire! Ug make rock! Ug make time machine!"

In *Timestreams*, you take the role of an inventor of the time machine, traveling the timelines to ensure that your own time remains dominant, seeding the ages with inventions that favor your era while trying to thwart other time travelers from relegating you to the dustbin of history!

Timestreams is a game in two parts. First, all players seed the timeline, working to plan the flow of history by playing inventions and actions. In each of six "days," players take turns filling a limited number of scoring slots, using actions and abilities on inventions to control the timelines. After all of the days are filled, the game moves to the second phase. During this phase players score points and use score abilities to further control the timeline. In the end, whichever player has seeded the timeline more effectively and scored the most points seizes control of the reality for all time, and emerges as the victor of *Timestreams*... at least this time...



GAME SETUP

Each player shuffles their deck and sets the cards aside. Place the Era cards in a row in age order (Stone Age - Medieval Era - Renaissance Period - Industrial Revolution - Modern Day - Future Tech):

This is the starting layout for a Timestreams game. Arrange the Era cards, oldest to newest, left to right:



The player playing the earliest deck takes the first turn in the first day. At the start of each new day, the first turn is taken by the next player in chronological order by deck. In a game with a Stone Age player and a Future Tech player, the Stone Age player goes first on the first day, the Future Tech player goes first on the second day, the Stone Age player goes first on the third day, and so on. Players do not necessarily take the first turn in their own era.



TURN ORDER

At the beginning of each day, each player draws cards from their deck, as shown by the Card Draw table. Unless cards indicate otherwise, this is the only point in the day that players draw cards.

Number of players:	Cards drawn at start of turn:
2	6
3	5
4-6*	4

*In a five or six player game each player discards two cards after drawing cards each age.

Beginning with the first player (as noted above) each player takes one of three actions:

- Play an Invention from their hand into the next slot of the current day
- Play an Action card and follow its text
- Pass and allow the next player to act

Playing Inventions

Each Invention you play is placed at the end of the stack in the current era, below any Inventions already in the current day. (The current day is called 'today' by cards and effects.) You may not play an Invention into any era other than the current era, unless a card effect says otherwise.



If the invention has a 'Play' effect, (Such as "Play: Draw a card.") you now execute that play effect. Cards may also have Score effects, but these are ignored until the score phase. Note that only the first six cards in an era will score, but it is legal to play additional Inventions, perhaps with the goal of destroying or moving other Inventions to ensure that your own Inventions will score. An age may hold any number of Inventions.

A note on invention types: some Inventions have additional traits.

- Art cards say "Invention - Art," and tend to affect other art cards. Any number of Art cards can exist in a single Era.
- Governments, labeled as "Invention - Government," represent the dominant ruling style in the era, and as such once one Government is in play in an era no additional Governments can be played into that era. If an effect discards or moves the Government out of the era, a new Government can be played. Similarly, it is not legal to use movement effects to move a Government into an era that already has a Government card.

Play an Action:

Instead of playing an Invention, you may play an action, using its effects to alter the timestream in your favor. Some actions are played on Inventions or eras; these cards are placed on the card they modify, and are



moved or discarded if the card they are on moves or is discarded.

PASS:

Players may instead pass, playing no cards. Passing does not prevent you from playing cards in future turns.

When all players pass in order, the day ends. At the end of each day, players keep all cards they are holding; there is no maximum hand size. The next day begins; players draw new cards and continue the fight to seed time in their favor.

SCORING:

After all players pass in the sixth day, (Future-Tech), the timeline is in place and time begins to flow. All players discard any remaining cards in their hands, and the first card in the first day (the Stone Age) is scored. If that card has a score effect, the player who played that card performs the action on that card. When the first card's score effect (if any) is finished, perform the score action on the second card, and so on. Each scoring slot (normally the first six cards) in the Stone Age is scored. After score effects are finished, any Inventions that are not in scoring slots (usually the first six cards) never make it into the

timeline and are discarded. Once all the scoring actions have been performed, players collect their Inventions. Each player takes all of their Inventions from scoring slots in the current era and places them into their score pile.

Each era is scored in turn, scoring only the first six cards (unless other effects add or subtract scoring slots). Once all six eras have been scored, the player with the most points wins!

The Wonky, Unnecessarily Complicated Movement Rule:

If a score effect moves a card that has not yet scored above it, it scores next (as long as there is still a score slot available in the current era). Think of it this way: Normally you score the first card, then the second card, and so on. If the second card has a score effect that moves the third card above it, that card still gets its score effect and scores next. In effect, each time you process a scoring slot, you start at the top of the era and score the first unscored card until you have scored the correct number of scoring slots of that era (usually 6).